Emotional (internalising) and conduct (externalising) problems in childhood.

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Contents

Document details 2

Overview 2

Defining emotional (internalising) and conduct (externalising) problems in NSHD 2

References 2

Variables in this document 2

Document details

Summary of work undertaken	Derived variables for emotional and conduct problems
Output variables	in1315g1, ext93pcg

Overview

Defining emotional (internalising) and conduct (externalising) problems in NSHD

Identification of conduct and emotional problems in NSHD was based on questions asked of teachers when study members were aged 13 and 15 years, using a forerunner of the Rutter A scale (Rutter et al., 1970; Elander & Rutter, 1996). Items for conduct problems refer to unpunctuality, restlessness, truancy, daydreaming, indiscipline, disobedience and lying. Items for emotional problems refer to anxiety, timidity, fearfulness, diffidence and avoidance of attention.

Summary measures of these problems were created by deriving global measures for each from factor analysis (using the statistical package Mplus, which allows for item level missing data), then dividing scores for these into absent, mild and severe based on established percentile cuts (Ghodsian et al., 1980; Ghodsian, 1983; Rodgers, 1990; Colman et al., 2009). For conduct problems these were 0-75%, 75-93% and 94% or higher, respectively; and for emotional problems these were 0-50%, 50-87% and 88% or higher, respectively. For both sets of problems the percentile cut for ‘severe’ was guided by epidemiological evidence to capture potentially clinically diagnosable disorders.

The variable names are **in1315g1** and **ext93pcg**, for emotional and conduct problems, respectively, and are coded 0, 1 and 2 for absent, mild or severe, as above. -999 refers to missing, but the user will need to define this as such.

References

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Elander J., Rutter M. Use and development of the Rutter parents’ and teachers’ scales. (1996) International Journal of Methods in Psychiatric Research, 6:63-78

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Ghodsian M., Fogelman K., Lambert L. & Tibbenham A. (1980) Changes in behaviour rating of a national sample of children. British Journal of Clinical Psychology, 19: 247-56

Rodgers, B. (1990) Behaviour and personality in childhood as predictors of adult psychiatric disorder. Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry, 31: 393-414.

Rutter M., Tizard J. & Whitmore K. (1970) Education, health and behaviour London: Longman.

Variables in this document

2 high-confidence matches

Variable	Label	How it was found
Questionnaire data [55] › Mental health [520] › Childhood mental health and personality [5209]		
ext93pcg	Conduct (externalising) problems - at age 13 and 15 years	topsheet field
in1315g1	Emotional (internalising) problems - at age 13 and 15 years	topsheet field

2 medium-confidence matches

Variable	Label	How it was found
Clinical data [51] › Physical measures [110] › Anthropometry [1102] › Body size measures [11021]		
scales	Serial number of scales - at age 53 years	prose scan
Clinical data [51] › Physical measures [110] › Hand examination [1106]		
problems	Any problems identifed with the hands - Hands Examinations 1999	prose scan